and *customers will be affected because of the downtime*. The costs also shoot up by ₹15 billion.

From the report, it is clear that the problems India faced after demonetization had been clearly analysed and spelt out by SBI in April 2016.

The only details in the public domain, regarding planning at the RBI, are from R. Gandhi, the Deputy Governor in charge of the currency management division. In an interview in April 2017,[8] on the day of his retirement, he described the note ban as a well thought-out and well-deliberated decision.

In his interview, he made a number of interesting statements:

- 'The consultations started in January. The introduction of ₹2,000 was a decision irrespective of demonetization.
- The decision to introduce ₹2,000 notes and the withdrawal of ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes were taken in parallel.
- *We planned everything. Every reaction was fully foreseen. There was no nasty surprise for us*. Everything had been well identified, and debated. Several instructions were given by us. But you need to analyse it differently. About 20 (notifications) were relaxing rules. These relaxations were also pre-planned. If at all, there were one or two without planning. The rest were planned.
- *The board was apprised only one day prior to the move* as we could not inform the board much in advance.'

Gandhi's statements seemed to indicate that the note ban had been planned since January 2016, at least within the currency management department of the RBI, making it even more shocking that its execution had been so flawed.[9]

What Was the Role of the RBI Governors?